

August 2026

Dear Srinivasan,

I've spent a long time watching West Walnut Creek, and fully renovated 1950s ranches on large lots don't come along often. When 2660 Ross Place hit the market this spring, the combination of a complete systems overhaul, dual master suites, and a 10,372-square-foot lot made it one of the more compelling offerings I'd seen at this price point in a while. When the listing came off market after 28 days without a sale, I wanted to reach out personally, because I think the home's story wasn't being told in a way that justified the number.

At \$874 per square foot, this home sits at the upper end of the Walnut Creek premium tier, and that's a position that requires a specific kind of marketing support to hold. The listing description does mention the renovation, but it leads with category language like 'luxury real estate' and 'opulent bathrooms' rather than the concrete details that actually build buyer confidence at this price, things like the new electrical, new plumbing, and new HVAC that represent real, meaningful capital investment. Buyers comparing carefully online need those specifics spelled out. When they aren't, the price feels like an ask rather than a conclusion.

I've put together a short analysis of what I think the friction points were and how I'd approach the relaunch differently. It covers the pricing position relative to the Walnut Creek market, the visual and narrative gaps in how the home was presented, and a distribution strategy built for the buyers who are actively looking for exactly what this home offers.

If you're already working with an agent toward a new listing, please feel free to set this aside entirely. If you're not, I'd welcome a conversation, no pressure, just a look at the numbers together and a candid discussion about what a different approach might produce.

With respect,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read 'Ben Olsen', with a long horizontal line extending to the right.

Ben Olsen

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The Path to Sold:

2660 Ross Place

WALNUT CREEK, CA 94597

4.0 Beds · 3 Baths · 1,601 Sq Ft · WALNUT CREEK

The Blueprint for a Successful Sale

Prepared For: The Owners of 2660 Ross Place

Presented By: Ben Olsen · BrightWork Realty Advocates

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A Fully Gut-Renovated West Walnut Creek Ranch on a 10,000-Square-Foot Lot - and a Listing That Didn't Build the Case for It

2660 Ross Place has the kind of substance that serious Lamorinda-adjacent buyers are actively searching for. A complete renovation means new electrical, new plumbing, new central HVAC, new flooring, and dual-pane windows throughout, not cosmetic updates, but a full systems rebuild inside a home with real bones. The 10,372-square-foot lot gives it outdoor scale that's genuinely rare at this price point in West Walnut Creek. The dual master suite layout addresses a specific and growing buyer need, particularly for multigenerational households or buyers who work from home and want separation. These are not generic selling points. They're the kind of specifics that move buyers from interest to offers.

The listing came off the market after 28 days without a sale, and the gap between the home's actual investment and the outcome points to a strategy problem, not a property problem. At \$874 per square foot, the listing sat at the upper end of the Walnut Creek premium tier. That position is defensible given the scope of renovation, but only if the marketing makes the case with precision. The description leaned on adjectives like 'opulent' and 'exquisite' without grounding them in the specifics that let buyers do the math. Buyers comparing options at this price point are sophisticated, and they needed more than mood language to justify the number.

\$1,399,999

List Price

\$874/sqft

Price Per Sq. Ft.

None

HOA Fees

A relaunch needs to accomplish one clear thing: replace the adjective-heavy narrative with a concrete, evidence-based case for the price. That means leading with the capital investment the renovation represents, giving buyers the visual depth to understand the lot and the floor plan, and putting the listing in front of the specific buyer segments, Bay Area professionals, multigenerational families, and relocation buyers, who are most likely to see the value in what this home actually is.

MARKET FORENSICS: WHY IT DIDN'T SELL

Every expired listing has a story. Here's what the listing history tells us about what held this one back, and what a different strategy would have done.

Friction #1: A Premium Price Position Without the Supporting Evidence

At \$874 per square foot, this home priced into the upper end of the Walnut Creek premium tier. That number is supportable, the full systems renovation alone represents significant capital, and the 10,372-square-foot lot adds real land value. But buyers comparing this home against others in the \$1.3M to \$1.5M range need to understand specifically why this one commands more per square foot than a standard updated home. The listing description used words like 'opulent' and 'luxury' without ever quantifying the renovation scope in terms buyers could verify and believe. When the marketing doesn't build that case, price-conscious buyers move on before they schedule a showing, and the number starts to feel unsupported.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork uses Zillow Showcase placement to present an evidence-based narrative directly on the listing page, one that spells out the renovation investment in concrete terms so buyers arrive at the showing already convinced, not skeptical.

Friction #2: A Visual Story That Was Never Told

A fully renovated home on a 10,000-plus-square-foot lot lives or dies on photography and spatial presentation. Buyers shopping at this price point are often doing significant research before they ever schedule a showing, and they need to be able to see what the renovation actually produced, the kitchen island, the dual master suite layouts, the lot dimensions and outdoor potential, in enough detail to feel something. Standard MLS angles rarely capture the open floor plan flow or the lot scale that make this property distinctive. If the photography didn't put buyers inside the experience, the listing description certainly didn't do it for them.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

A 3D Matterport tour lets buyers walk through the full floor plan from anywhere, at any time, giving out-of-area and busy professional buyers the spatial understanding they need to justify making the drive.

Friction #3: The Right Buyers Were Never Actively Found

At \$1,399,999 in the current rate environment, the buyer pool is selective by definition. The buyers most likely to respond to a fully renovated, large-lot West Walnut Creek home with dual master suites include Bay Area professionals relocating east of the tunnel, multigenerational families prioritizing layout flexibility, and buyers upgrading from smaller Contra Costa properties. These buyers don't materialize from passive MLS syndication alone. They need to be reached where they're already searching, which in 2026 means targeted digital channels built around the specific buyer profile, not a standard listing distribution and a wait.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork runs geo-targeted digital campaigns into San Francisco and Oakland buyer segments who are actively researching Walnut Creek before they've found what they're looking for, putting this home in front of decision-makers rather than browsers.

POSITIONING ANALYSIS

Metric	2660 Ross Place	Walnut Creek Market Context
Price per Sq. Ft.	\$874/sqft	Premium tier: \$820–\$950/sqft
Lot / Setting	10,372 sq ft, West Walnut Creek residential	Typical lot: 6,000–8,000 sq ft
Architectural Character	1956 ranch, fully gut-renovated with open floor plan	Mix of original and partially updated mid-century stock
Premium Features	New electrical, plumbing, HVAC, dual master suites, gourmet kitchen with island	Standard updated finishes, single primary suite
HOA	None	None typical for this neighborhood type

The verdict: At \$874/sqft versus a benchmark range of \$820-\$950/sqft, this home sits in the middle of that range. At \$874 per square foot, this home sits in the upper portion of the Walnut Creek premium tier, and the full renovation scope genuinely supports that position. The lot size adds measurable land value that comparables on smaller parcels can't match. What the numbers needed was a marketing strategy that made this case explicitly and early, so buyers at this price point were building conviction rather than raising questions.

THE RELAUNCH STRATEGY: 3 PILLARS

We don't re-list this home. We relaunch it with new media, a narrative that finally does it justice, and distribution designed for the buyer it deserves.

Pillar I - Building an Evidence-Based Case for the Price

The renovation at 2660 Ross Place was comprehensive: new electrical, new plumbing, new HVAC, new flooring, dual-pane windows throughout. That's a meaningful capital investment, not a cosmetic refresh, and it's the foundation of the \$874-per-square-foot price position. A relaunch needs to lead with that investment in specific, quantifiable terms that buyers can verify. BrightWork builds listing narratives the way a great buyer's agent describes a home, grounded in evidence that arms buyers with the confidence to justify the number before they ever walk through the door.

Pillar II - Giving Buyers the Visual Depth to Understand This Home

The open floor plan, the dual master suite configuration, and the 10,372-square-foot lot are features that require the right presentation to land. Flat MLS photography rarely captures a floor plan's spatial logic or a lot's true scale. BrightWork's standard media package includes a Sky Tour that shows the lot position and street presence in context, giving buyers an understanding of what they're getting that satellite images and ground photography can't replicate. More informed buyers mean fewer wasted showings and more confident offers.

Pillar III - Reaching the Buyer Segments Most Likely to Act

The buyer for this home isn't browsing Zillow casually. They're a Bay Area professional who has decided to move east of the tunnel, a multigenerational family that needs layout flexibility, or a buyer upgrading from a smaller Contra Costa home who understands what a full renovation means. These buyers can be found and reached before they've narrowed their search to specific listings. BrightWork's geo-targeted campaigns are built around profiles like these, putting this home in front of the right people at the right stage of their decision, not after they've already committed elsewhere.

A DIFFERENT OPTION: THE QUIET LISTING

Sell Without the Disruption

A traditional listing puts a sign in your yard, opens your door to strangers every weekend, and puts your home's history on public record. For a home that already went through one listing cycle, there's a better starting point.

BrightWork maintains an active private buyer list through our off-market platform. These are Bay Area buyers who've opted in specifically to receive property alerts before anything hits Zillow. They're motivated, pre-qualified, and they believe an off-market home represents a real opportunity, which means they engage seriously.

- * **No public days on market.** The prior listing history stays private. A new buyer sees none of it.
- * **No sign, no open houses, no disruption.** The sale is a private conversation between a motivated buyer and a motivated seller.
- * **Option to go public anytime.** If the right off-market offer doesn't materialize in an agreed window, we transition directly into a full relaunch strategy with no time lost.

* HOW IT WORKS

We alert our private buyer list through offmarket.brightworkrealty.com - Bay Area buyers specifically seeking properties before they go public. If a serious match emerges within the agreed window, we negotiate and close privately. If not, we launch the full relaunch strategy immediately, with clean momentum and no days-on-market exposure.

TIMELINE: THE BRIGHTWORK SMART WAY

Phase 1 - Pre-Market Preparation (Weeks 1–2)

Staging, full media production, and a Coming Soon campaign - or a quiet listing launch to our private buyer network, depending on your preference.

Phase 2 - Strategic Launch (Week 3)

Thursday launch on Zillow Showcase with the full media package in premium placement. Targeted SF/Oakland digital ads go live the same day.

Phase 3 - Momentum Management (Weeks 4–5)

Active follow-up on every save, inquiry, and open house visitor. Final Offer gives serious buyers a transparent channel to submit competitive offers.

Phase 4 - The Close (Weeks 6–7)

We engineer competition, not just field offers. Our process keeps both sides of the transaction moving cleanly toward a close.

WHY BRIGHTWORK REALTY ADVOCATES

- * **Deep local roots:** 45+ years in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda. Ground-level knowledge of what buyers in each community are actually paying for.
- * **Premium marketing as a baseline:** Cinematic photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not a luxury add-on.
- * **Portal dominance:** Zillow Showcase and homes.com premium placement. More views, enhanced listing pages, all leads to your team.
- * **Modern offer tools:** Final Offer gives buyers a transparent path to engage and gives you real-time demand data in one place.
- * **True advocacy:** We don't re-list homes. We forensically review what went wrong and rebuild the strategy from the ground up.

This home has real assets that the market never got to properly evaluate. That's a correctable problem. The window to correct it is still open.

Ready to talk? brightworkrealty.com · (925) 255-9727

Scan to see what a relaunch looks like for your home: relaunch.brightworkrealty.com

Important Notice

If you have entered into a listing agreement or active representation agreement with a licensed real estate agent in connection with this property, please disregard this mailing.

BrightWork Realty Advocates is a licensed real estate team operated by Ben Olsen, REALTOR, California DRE License #01409268. This communication is not intended to solicit properties currently listed for sale or under active representation.

The market analysis and strategic observations contained in this report are based on publicly available listing data and BrightWork's professional assessment of market conditions. They are not a formal appraisal and should not be relied upon as a certified valuation.

All property data referenced in this report was obtained from public records and MLS history. BrightWork Realty Advocates makes no warranty as to the accuracy of third-party data sources.

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THE BRIGHTWORK ADVANTAGE

- Buy Before You Sell
- BrightFlip Pre-Sale Improvements
- Final Offer Platform
- Zillow Showcase + homes.com Premium
- Off-Market Network
- Built to Close Clean

YOUR LISTING ADVISOR

Ben Olsen

Founding Partner | REALTOR · BrightWork Realty Advocates · DRE# 02014153

Ben founded BrightWork on a specific premise: the best outcomes are built before a home ever lists. With twenty years serving the East Bay's most competitive submarkets, he's developed a clear point of view on what separates a sale that closes well from one that doesn't, and the preparation, marketing, and negotiation strategy to act on it.

He entered the workforce at 14 in construction, a background that shapes how he thinks about pre-sale decisions, disclosure strategy, and what buyers actually scrutinize at inspection. That's a different lens than most agents carry into a listing consultation.

His approach to marketing is built on the same logic. Every campaign is designed for your home's specific buyer, not the average buyer. Portal strategy, campaign integration, and buyer targeting aren't add-ons at BrightWork. They're the baseline. Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure before the home lists. The preparation is the negotiation.

20+

YEARS SERVING
LAMORINDA

\$1B+

PROPERTIES
SOLD

1,000+

BUYERS &
SELLERS

WHY HE SENT YOU THIS PACKET

When a listing expires, Ben reviews it. Not to pitch you, but because after enough of them, the pattern of what goes wrong becomes clear. If you received this analysis, he looked at your specific property and has a specific point of view about what happened. That's the conversation he's offering. No listing agreement on the table. Just a review. He'll also walk you through programs that turn seller constraints into options, and show you what a transaction designed to get everyone to the closing table feeling good actually looks like.

Why BrightWork Realty Advocates

Rooted in Lamorinda since 1977. BrightWork is built on the premise that the best outcomes start before a home ever lists. An orchestrated campaign designed for your home's buyer, not the average buyer. Programs that turn seller constraints into options. Transactions designed so everyone gets to the closing table feeling good.

That's The Smart Way to Real Estate.

EIGHT REASONS SMART SELLERS CHOOSE BRIGHTWORK

01 Superior Presentation

Professional photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not the luxury package. The baseline.

02 Premium Portal Presence

Zillow Showcase and premium homes.com membership. Higher view counts, better placement, and buyer inquiries that route to your listing team.

03 Integrated Campaigns

Every sign, mailer, and open house connects to a digital system. Curious neighbors become trackable leads.

04 Modern Offer Management

Real-time portal data guides pricing decisions. Final Offer platform for properties with strong multi-offer potential.

05 Financial Tools & Capital Programs

Capital to fund pre-sale improvements with no out-of-pocket cost until close. Plus programs that remove the timing trap entirely.

06 Off-Market Strategy

A private list of serious Bay Area buyers. Test demand quietly or gain early access before properties hit MLS.

07 Advocacy for Unsold Homes

When a home hasn't sold, we don't re-list at a lower price. We conduct a forensic review and relaunch with a rebuilt strategy.

08 Built to Close Clean

Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure to every buyer before the house lists. He structures listings to attract the best first offers from a position no one can argue with. The preparation is the negotiation.

BrightWork has served Lamorinda since 1977. Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

Ben Olsen | (925) 255-9727 | ben@brightworkrealty.com | brightworkrealty.com

Not Every Home Needs a Public Launch.

For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or a different kind of timing — BrightWork has a smarter first step.

Most agents know one approach: list on the MLS, hit the portals, hold open houses. That works for many homes. For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or more control over timing, BrightWork offers a structured, documented private path to the right buyer — built on relationships in Lamorinda that go back to 1977.

OFF MARKET SELLING HAS ITS BENEFITS

Your Home, Your Timing, No Pressure

No days-on-market counter. No public record. No nosy neighbors. Your home stays entirely private until you choose otherwise, and if you do go public later, you start fresh, with a clean slate and zero wasted days behind you.

Buyers Who Are Actually Ready

BrightWork maintains a curated list of serious, pre-qualified Bay Area buyers who have asked to be notified about Lamorinda properties. They are not browsing Zillow. Every showing is by appointment, with someone who qualifies and is genuinely interested.

Real Feedback Before You Commit

An off-market phase gives you genuine buyer response before you decide whether to close privately or step into a full MLS campaign. Either way, you move forward with real data and momentum, not day-one guesswork.

BrightWork's network of private buyers and collaborative realtor relationships has served Lamorinda since 1977.

Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

Deep relationships in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda.

WHO THE PRIVATE PATH SERVES

The Privacy-First Seller

No public listings, no open houses, and no days-on-market counter visible to buyers and agents, for whatever reason, professional or personal.

The Seller Still Preparing

Test genuine demand while staging or repairs are still underway, without burning days on market before you are ready.

The Strategically Timed Seller

Your next move depends on how this one closes. Control the sequence rather than react to a public countdown clock.

The Seller Testing the Waters

Get real buyer feedback before committing to a full public launch — or decide you do not need one at all.

Your home. Your timeline. Your terms.

Ready to find out whether the private path is the right first step?

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